

WEB DESIGN STUDIO

HERO ANIMATION

3D / MOTION

ASSEMBLY CONCEPT

Assembling *Intelligence* Made Visible

A whimsical, premium 3D hero animation where separate interface fragments enter from every direction and compose themselves into a complete landing page — live, in front of the viewer.

PROJECT TYPE

Hero Animation ·
Loopable

DURATION

6–8 sec intro · 3–4 sec idle
loop

DELIVERY

WebGL / Lottie /
Video

DATE

May
2026

The Page That Builds Itself

The animation opens on a warm cream void — still, quiet, expectant. Then, one by one, **3D interface fragments begin to arrive**: a hero browser window sliding in from the upper left trailing a gentle rotation, a typography panel rising from below the frame, a sage-green image placeholder drifting in from the right with a soft parallax spin. Each piece has **weight, material presence, and intention**. They are not random objects — they are recognisable parts of a real website being constructed before the viewer's eyes.

Over six to eight seconds, these fragments converge, guided by an invisible hand, settling with precise, satisfying clicks into a unified landing page composition — **premium, warm, designed**. The metaphor is clear: this studio doesn't just make pretty things, it assembles intelligence into form. Once built, the composition breathes gently in a subtle idle loop, inviting the viewer to lean in. The feeling is closer to watching a master craftsperson arrange a letterpress layout than to watching software render — deliberate, tactile, and quietly magical.

What the Assembled Scene Looks Like

The final composition occupies the **right 45–50% of the hero area**, mirroring the spatial logic of the Yellow Goat Co. reference. The assembled "page" is viewed at a **subtle 3/4 perspective tilt** — roughly 8–12° on the Y-axis and 3–5° on the X-axis — giving it dimensional weight without distorting readability.

COMPOSITION STRUCTURE

At the centre sits the **main hero browser window** — large, matte cream, with three coloured dots (terracotta, mustard, sage) at the top-left and a bold serif headline reading "Design. Build. Elevate." Below it, a call-to-action button in terracotta. Layered behind and to the right, a **sage-coloured grid panel** with a wave blob shape and golden circle accent. To the lower-left, a **wireframe layout card** showing a placeholder image cross and ruled text lines. Orbiting the stack at a slight angle: a thin golden wire ring echoing the circular motifs in the Yellow Goat identity.

Satellite elements float at varying depths around the main stack: a typography card ("Aa" with colour swatches), a dark charcoal code block (syntax-highlighted lines in sage/mustard/terra), a toolbar strip (B / I / link / align icons), a pen tool coin, and two or three small geometric primitives — cubes and spheres — as visual punctuation. Nothing touches the left-hand text area. The entire composition fits within a roughly **560 × 480px notional frame**, centred in its half of the hero.

How the Pieces Move

Motion is **orchestrated, not simultaneous**. Think of it as a conductor bringing in sections of an orchestra — staggered entries, each with its own character, resolving into a chord.

"Each element has one job: travel from its unique origin, arrive at its exact place, and settle as if it always belonged there."

- **Stagger:** 80–120ms between each element's start
- **Rotation:** Each piece rotates ± 8 – 18° during travel, straightening on arrival
- **Overshoot:** 4–6px spring overshoot on final position, then settle
- **Opacity:** Begin at 0, reach full opacity over first 30% of each element's travel
- **Entry easing:** Cubic bezier (0.16, 1, 0.3, 1) — fast out, ease in
- **Z-depth travel:** Some elements begin 60–80px "behind" scene, push forward
- **Scale:** Elements enter at 0.88–0.94 scale, reach 1.0 on landing
- **Idle float:** ± 3 px Y drift, 0.4° rotation oscillation, 4–6s sinusoidal period

The cursor element deserves special treatment: it should **enter last**, gliding in from the right edge as if a human just moved the mouse into frame, and come to rest hovering over the CTA button — pressing it with a subtle scale pulse before releasing. This single gesture communicates "this is a real, interactive website."

Beat-by-Beat Sequence

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- 0:00 – 0:20** **Hold on void.** Scene is empty. Warm cream background fades up from slightly cooler tone. A single golden orbital ring appears with opacity, rotating slowly in 3D. Sets the quiet, expectant mood before anything arrives.
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- 0:20 – 0:55** **First arrivals — background layer.** The sage grid panel slides in from the upper-right, rotating ~14° on arrival then correcting. Simultaneously, the dark code-block panel enters from the lower-right, slightly further in Z-depth. Both settle into their rear positions.
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- 0:55 – 1:40** **Mid-ground elements arrive.** The wireframe card rises from below-frame, gently spinning. The typography "Aa" card glides in from the far left with a subtle tilt. The sage text-lines card enters from lower-left. The orbital wire ring animates its second arc into view.
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- 1:40 – 2:60** **Hero window descends.** The main browser window — the largest element — enters from *above*, slightly in front of the viewer (closer Z). It descends with a confident, unhurried pace, a gentle 6° forward tilt correcting as it slots into place at centre. This is the scene's centrepiece arriving; give it the most screen time and the most precise landing.
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- 2:60 – 3:40** **Decorative satellites fill in.** Small cubes and spheres blink into existence from near-distance, drifting to their positions. The pen-tool coin rises from below the main stack. The toolbar strip slides up from the bottom edge. Mustard wavy ribbon enters from lower-right.
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- 3:40 – 4:20** **Cursor enters.** A matte black pointer glides in from the right, arcing gently to hover over the CTA button. It pauses for half a beat, then the button depresses slightly (1–2px drop, subtle shadow change) — a click. The cursor lifts. Everything has clicked into place, literally and figuratively.
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- 4:20 – 5:00** **Scene settles.** All elements reach their final positions. A brief full-composition hold (0.4–0.6s) at rest — the viewer reads the whole assembled page.
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5:00 → ∞

Idle loop begins. Each element begins its individual sinusoidal float. Different phases per element so nothing moves in unison. The orbital ring continues its slow rotation. The cursor drifts lazily. The scene breathes. If looping, the cursor exit and re-entry can serve as the loop transition point.

3D Components Required



Hero Browser Window

Main centre card. Cream matte, serif headline "Design. Build. Elevate.", terracotta CTA button, traffic light dots. Largest element at ~1.4× relative scale.



Sage Grid Panel

Rear-right background card. Sage matte with a subtle dot/grid texture, wavy organic blob shape in cream, golden disc accent. Positioned behind main window.



Wireframe Layout Card

Lower-front card. Cream panel with wireframe image placeholder (X-cross box), ruled text line stubs. Reads as a layout skeleton / lo-fi mockup card.



Dark Code Block

Charcoal-black panel with three lines of syntax-coloured "code" in sage, mustard, and terracotta. Adds contrast and signals the technical craft behind the work.

Aa

Typography Card

Square cream card with large "Aa" in a premium serif, below it a row of five colour swatches (terra, mustard, sage, cream, charcoal). Design system artefact.



Sage Text-Lines Card

Small sage rectangle with embossed horizontal lines suggesting body copy, and a little mustard squiggle decorative element underneath. Signals content / editorial layer.



Toolbar Strip

Horizontal cream pill with Bold / Italic / Link / Align icon symbols. Reads as a rich-text editor toolbar. Subtle raised surface. Thin, wide proportions.



Pen Tool Coin

Circular disc, mustard-golden, with an embossed pen nib / Bézier node symbol. References the craft of graphic design. Floats between the main cards.



Code Icon Tile

Small square tile in terracotta with embossed </> symbol. Positioned upper-right of scene. Signals development capability alongside design.



Orbital Wire Ring

Single thin golden wire ring / halo, 3D-tilted, encircling the main composition. Echoes the circular motif in Yellow Goat's own branding. Rotates slowly in idle.



Cursor / Pointer

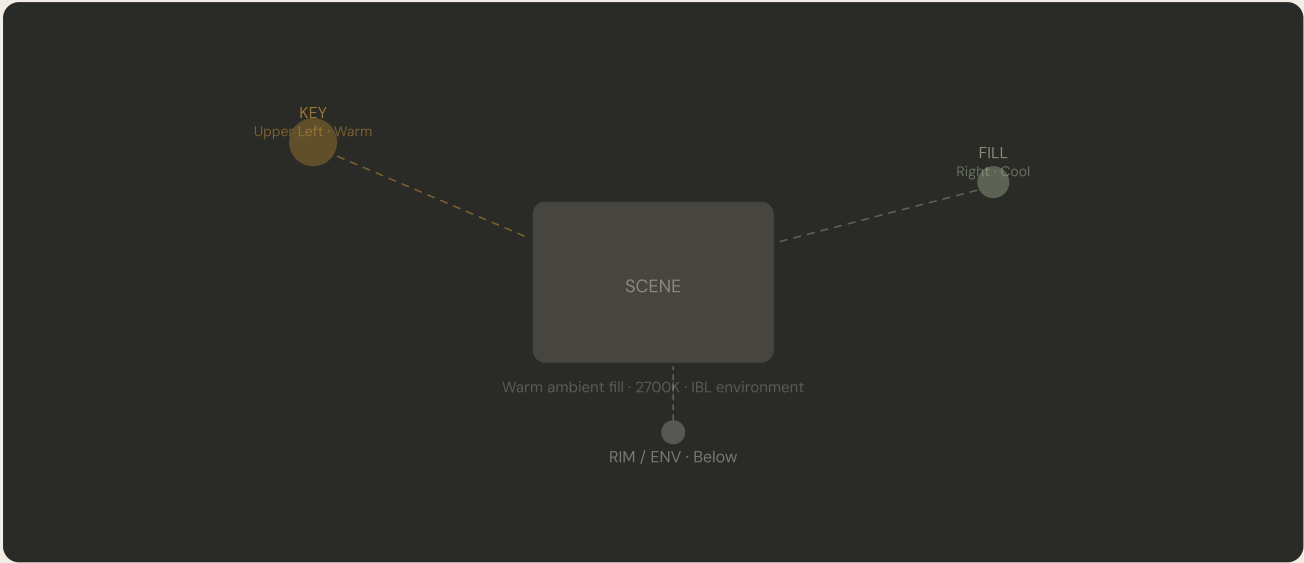
Classic OS arrow cursor in deep matte charcoal. Mildly oversized for legibility. Enters last, interacts with CTA, lingers in idle. The human touch in the scene.



Geometric Primitives

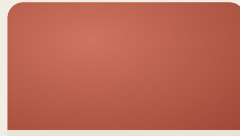
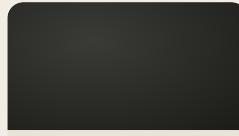
3–4 small cubes and spheres in mustard, sage, and terra. No function — pure visual rhythm and breathing room. Scattered at scene edges like punctuation marks.

Studio Lighting Arrangement



LIGHT	DESCRIPTION
Key Light	Soft area light, upper-left, slightly warm (3200K). Primary source of dimension. Gentle falloff — no hard shadows. Intensity ~1.2. This creates the main highlight ridge on all card surfaces.
Fill Light	Cooler, lower-intensity area light from the right (5500K, intensity ~0.35). Keeps shadow areas from going muddy. Lifts the cream surfaces on the right side of each card.
Rim / Back	Very soft backlight from below, nearly invisible. Prevents elements from merging with the background at their base. Creates the subtle translucent edge glow on lighter panels.
Environment (IBL)	HDRI studio environment at low rotation. Provides natural inter-reflections between cards — the warm cream environment bounces onto neighbouring surfaces. Intensity ~0.6.
Ambient Occlusion	Subtle contact shadows where cards overlap. Radius: 0.4–0.8 units. Keep it soft — enough to read depth layering without darkening the composition.
Shadows	Soft area shadows, blurred radius 6–12px equivalent. Cast only onto background and onto cards directly below. No hard shadow edges. Shadow colour: warm tinted dark (#1C1814 at 30% opacity).

Surfaces, Finishes, and Tactile Qualities

				
Matte Cream Roughness 0.72 · No specular	Sage Clay Roughness 0.78 · Subsurface 0.05	Mustard Satin Roughness 0.55 · Slight sheen	Terracotta Roughness 0.68 · Warm SSS	Deep Charcoal Roughness 0.82 · Matte black

All primary surfaces use a **plaster/clay PBR material**: high roughness (0.65–0.80), near-zero metalness, very subtle micro-normal texture (paper or fine linen grain at about 5% normal intensity). This gives everything a **tactile, handmade quality** without reading as rough or dirty. The goal is "premium matte" — like a quality business card or a perfectly finished architectural model.

Card edges should have **chamfered rounds of 0.06–0.10 units** — enough to catch light along the rim and define volume, not enough to read as toy-like. The main browser window gets a slightly larger chamfer (0.12) since it's the hero element. The orbital wire ring uses a thin tubular mesh with the mustard satin material — slight sheen there is intentional and adds a sense of precious, jewellery-like quality to a simple geometric form.

No glass, no chrome, no reflective surfaces. The only exception: the mustard pen-tool coin and orbital ring have very gentle specular at roughness 0.45–0.55, suggesting metal but keeping it warm and muted. All other reflections should read as sub-surface warmth, not surface gloss.

Keeping It Whimsical Without Losing Premium

"Whimsy is not chaos. It is precision wearing a gentle smile."

The line between *charming* and *childish* is thinner than it looks. Here is how to stay on the right side of it:

- Use serif typography on cards — signals craft, not cartoon
- Mute all colours — no pure saturated hues, ever
- Earn every element — if it doesn't serve the layout story, cut it
- Motion is never bouncy — spring is subtle, not cartoonish
- No particle effects, no glow, no lens flare — none
- Keep scale relationships realistic — no comically large or tiny pieces
- Let negative space breathe — resist the urge to fill it
- Gravity should feel implied — pieces float, but with weight
- Shadows must always be correct — wrong shadows kill premium fast
- Typography on 3D cards must be legible, not decorative

The secret weapon here is **restraint**. The reference image succeeds because every element earns its place and the warm, consistent lighting unifies the whole. If at any point the scene starts to feel like a software product screenshot or a tech startup motion reel — pull back. The reference is closer to product photography than to UI animation. Think **still-life oil painting**, but assembled in real time.

For the 3D Artist / Motion Designer

PARAMETER	RECOMMENDED VALUE / APPROACH
Software	Blender 4.x (Cycles or Eevee Next) preferred for web-pipeline exports. Cinema 4D + Redshift or Octane also ideal. Three.js / Spline for real-time WebGL delivery.
Animation format	For web delivery: export as optimised WebM (VP9) or h.264 MP4 with alpha if needed. Lottie/Rive only if scene complexity permits real-time. Pre-rendered video is the safest premium path.
Resolution	Render at 2× target: 2400 × 2000px minimum. Final crop to the right-column area of the hero. On Retina, 1200 × 1000px at 2× DPR is the target viewport size.
Frame rate	60fps for any WebGL/Rive path. 30fps acceptable for pre-rendered video; 60fps preferred for high-end delivery. Always export at 60fps source even if downsizing.
Camera	50mm–75mm equivalent focal length. Perspective transform minimal (not isometric, not fish-eye). Slight Y-axis rotation (8–12°) and X-axis tilt (3–5°) gives depth without distortion.
Scene scale	Work in real-world centimetres if possible. Main browser window ~28cm × 18cm. This keeps lighting, shadow, and physically-based material parameters intuitive.
Animation curves	Use custom graph-editor easing — avoid linear or default Blender bezier. Every element needs its own custom ease-out-elastic or ease-out-expo curve. Do not use pre-set physics simulations for the assembly; hand-key everything for precision.
Geometry detail	Chamfer / Bevel modifier on all card edges (2 segments, 0.08–0.12 unit width). Subdivision Surface at level 2 for curves if needed. Keep poly count manageable for real-time: target 50k tris total for scene if going WebGL.
Idle loop technique	Animate idle float on separate NLA strip (Blender) or as a separate Action layer. Offset start frame per object using a driver or simple expression (<code>frame_start = object_index × 12</code>). Ensures no two objects float in phase.

Background

Pure #F2EDE4 environment. No gradients in 3D — control warmth entirely through lighting. If compositing: extract on white, composite onto brand cream in After Effects or CSS.

Tasteful Extras to Elevate the Magic

01

Micro-dust Motes

A handful of nearly invisible tiny particles drifting slowly through the scene lit by the key light. At 3–4% opacity they suggest atmosphere and a warm dusty studio without reading as a "particle effect." Like old film grain, but spatial.

02

Cursor Interaction Trail

As the cursor glides in, it leaves the faintest motion-blur ghost — not a particle trail, just a very subtle opacity smear from the cursor's motion path. Disappears instantly. Adds a sense of weight and physicality to a vector object.

03

Procedural Micro-text

The text lines on cards are actual short words or fragments of real copywriting ("Dream / Design / Launch / Convert") — tiny but readable on close inspection. The level of craft rewards curious viewers and signals attention to detail.

04

Card Face Reflections

Matte cards should reflect only neighbouring card colours — a faint sage tint on the underside of the wireframe card from the sage panel below it. Purely from the IBL and inter-reflection, not added manually. Confirms the physics of the scene.

05

Progress Reveal: Left-to-Right

Coordinate the animation timing with the page's text fade-in on the left so they feel choreographed as one event — the hero heading types in as the 3D builds on the right. Maximum emotional impact when both sides arrive together.

06

Scroll-Driven Parallax

Once assembled, individual cards respond to cursor or scroll position with a $\pm 4\text{px}$ / $\pm 1.5^\circ$ parallax offset — deeper cards moving less, foreground cards more. Creates the sense of real 3D space on a flat screen. Implementable with CSS scroll-timeline or GSAP.

Priority order: Nail the assembly choreography first. If the entrance and landing moments are satisfying, everything else is polish. A beautifully timed assembly with a clean idle loop is a complete deliverable. Add enhancements only after the core is locked.

